

From 15,099 player-seasons to a scouting shortlist

The SQL query (Filter 1) sets a tighter 41-game minimum that automatically removes injury cases. Filter 2 removes age-managed veterans.

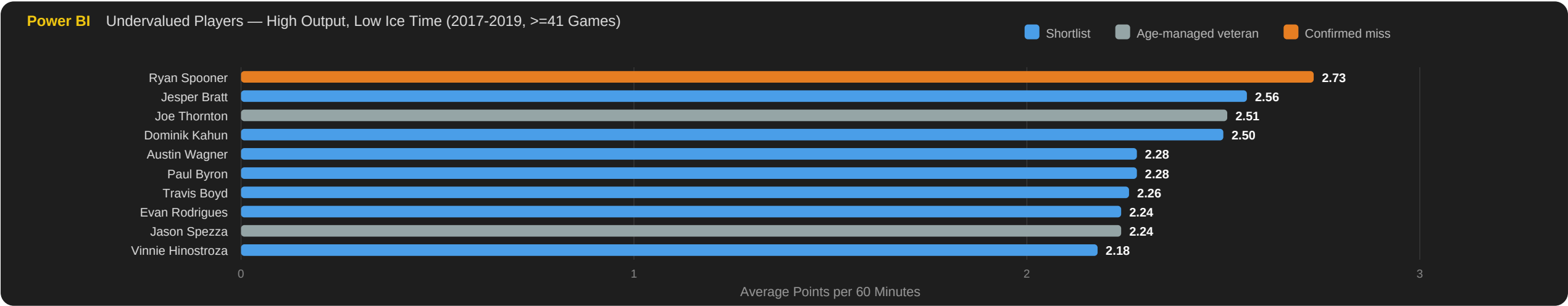
Filter 1 — SQL
Underused + high impact
>=41 games, 2017-2019
15,099 -> 10

Filter 2 — Analyst
Remove age-managed veterans
10 -> 8

Result — Shortlist
Genuine coaching & roster underutilisation
8 names

Validation
After 2019 outcomes checked
7 of 8

FILTER 1 OUTPUT — POWER BI DASHBOARD · mart_player_season · >=41 games, 2017-2019, sorted by avg pts/60



Filter 2 — Joe Thornton (removed)
Two major knee injuries plus natural age-related minutes management at 38. Hall of Fame 2023. A veteran gracefully managed, not undervalued.

Filter 2 — Jason Spezza (removed)
Voluntarily signed a minimum contract at 36 to play for his hometown team in a mentor role. Limited ice time by mutual agreement, not undervaluation.

8 names on the shortlist — what happened after 2019?

After the SQL filter removes injury cases and the analyst filter removes age-managed veterans, 8 players remain. Dataset ends 2019.

REAL-WORLD OUTCOMES AFTER 2019 · Verified June 2026

Jesper Bratt2.56 New Jersey Devils franchise cornerstone & alternate captain. 168G/336A in 622 games. Franchise cornerstone	Evan Rodrigues2.24 Won the Stanley Cup with Colorado Avalanche in 2022. Now Florida Panthers. Stanley Cup winner	Travis Boyd2.26 Career-high 17G/35pts with Arizona when given real ice time — double his Washington minutes. Breakout elsewhere
Paul Byron2.28 Named alternate captain at Montreal Canadiens. 98 career goals, 208 career points. Alternate captain	Vinnie Hinostroza2.18 Still active NHL 2025-26 with Florida Panthers. Double-digit goals twice. Still active NHL	Dominik Kahun2.50 Contributed for Pittsburgh & Edmonton. 83 career points. Now Lausanne HC, Switzerland. Multi-team contributor
Austin Wagner2.28 Reliable bottom-6 forward. Now playing in the KHL (Shanghai Dragons). Bottom-6 career	Ryan Spooner2.73 Left NHL after 2019. Now in the KHL. Never sustained performance across teams. Confirmed miss	

7 of 8 shortlisted players had meaningful or notable NHL careers after 2019

The SQL filter (>=41 games) removed injury cases automatically. Evan Rodrigues won the Stanley Cup in 2022. Travis Boyd posted career highs when given real ice time elsewhere. The one miss — Ryan Spooner — is catchable in a multi-team consistency check.

Where do shots actually become goals?

The slot converts at 19.46% — six times higher than wing shots. Practice time should follow the data, not tradition.

19.46%

Slot conversion rate

6x

More effective than the wings

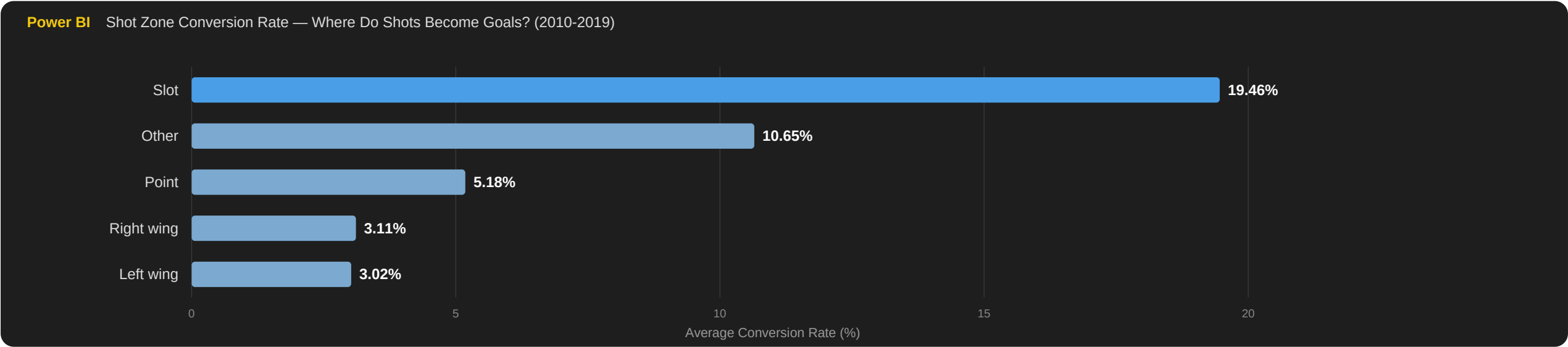
9 vs 33

Slot vs wing shots per goal

1.7M+

Shot events analysed (2010-19)

POWER BI DASHBOARD · mart_shot_zones · conversion rate by zone, 2010-2019



The finding

Slot shots convert at 19.46% vs ~3% from the wings. The hierarchy holds across every season 2010-2019. Pre-2010 excluded (100% missing coordinates).

The recommendation

Drill slot positioning and finishing, not perimeter technique. The problem is rarely the shot — it is where the player is standing when they take it.

When do penalties actually cost games?

A Period 3 Game Misconduct correlates with losing two times out of three. A Period 1 Minor is a coin flip. Severity and timing both matter.

68.65%

Period 3 Game Misconduct loss rate

50.82%

Period 1 Minor — a coin flip

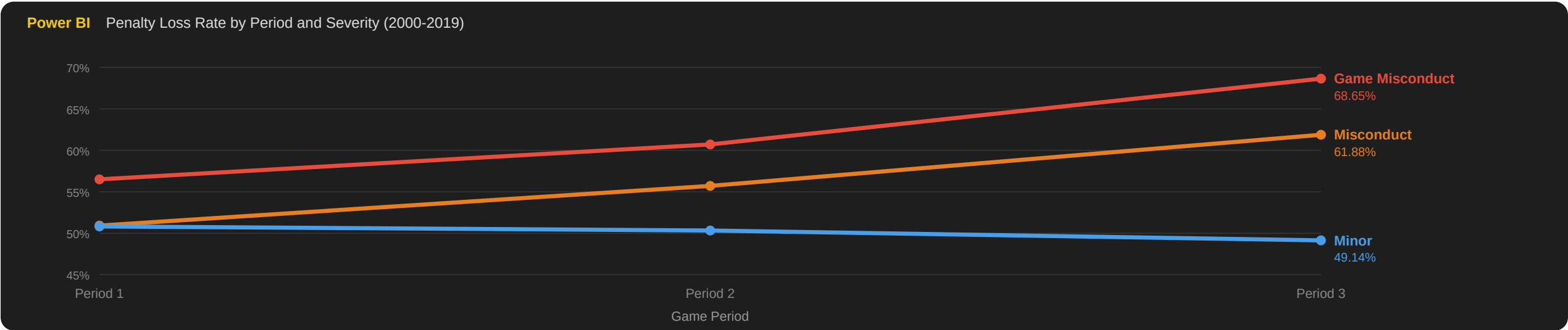
12pp

P3 vs P1 gap, same penalty type

247K+

Penalty records analysed

POWER BI DASHBOARD · mart_penalty_cost · loss rate by period and severity, 2000-2019



Correlation, not causation

Teams already losing may take more desperate penalties. But the same penalty type carries a 12-point higher loss rate in Period 3 than Period 1 — if score state alone explained it, that gap would be far smaller. Severity and timing carry independent signal.

The recommendation

Coach discipline differently by period. A Period 1 Minor is noise. A Period 3 Game Misconduct costs the game two times out of three. The pre-Period-3 locker room message should be specifically about composure.

How much does home ice actually matter?

Home ice advantage is worth +13 to +22 percentage points in win probability at top NHL venues — and nearly a full extra goal per game.

+13-22pp

Win rate uplift at top home venues

+0.9

More goals per game at home

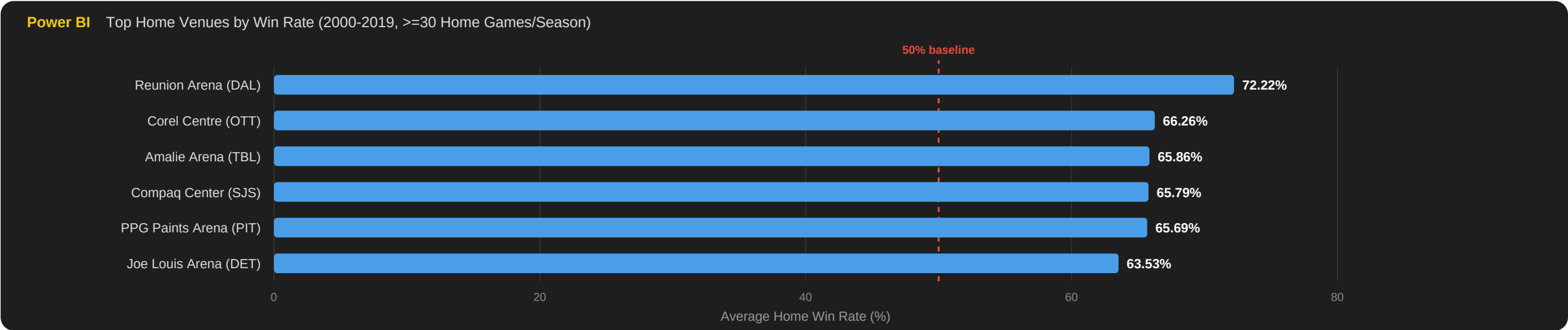
65.86%

Tampa Bay Lightning at Amalie Arena

All teams

Every venue between 55-72% home wins

POWER BI DASHBOARD · mart_venue_advgtg · top home venues by win rate, >=30 home games/season, 2000-2019



The finding

Every qualifying venue wins between 55% and 72% at home — home advantage is league-wide, not arena-specific. Home teams also score ~0.9 more goals per game. (Reunion Arena is a small-sample outlier.)

The recommendation

Finishing top of the division to earn home playoff games is worth more than most trade deadline acquisitions. In a Game 7, home ice is the difference between a coin flip and winning two times out of three.

Which franchises are rising or falling?

A 3-year rolling win rate classifies every franchise by consistent directional momentum as of 2019 — before the standings confirmed it.

9 / 12 / 12

Rising / stable / falling franchises

+11.17pp

Colorado Avalanche — largest rise

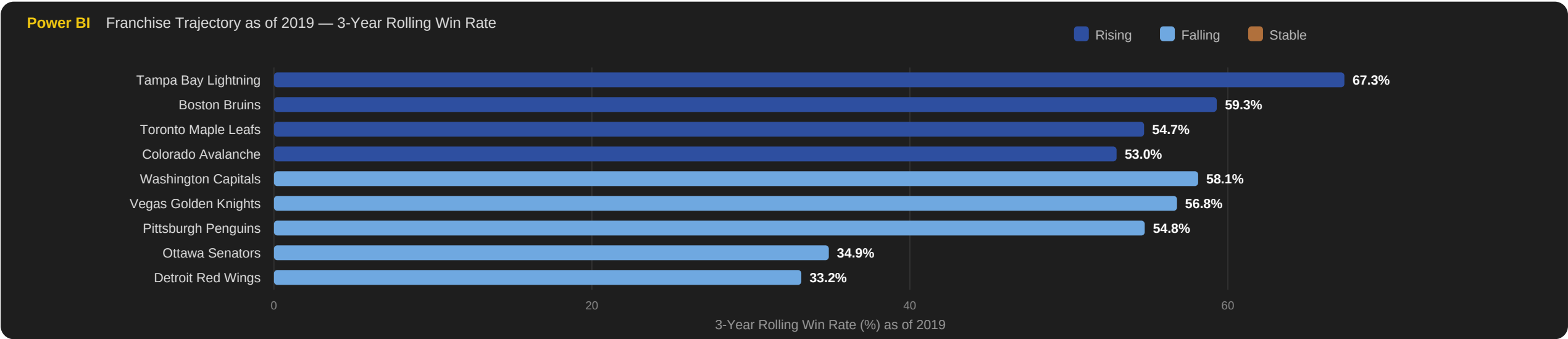
-10.07pp

Ottawa Senators — steepest fall

momentum

Consistent 3-season direction, not net change

POWER BI DASHBOARD · mart_team_traject_rolling · 3-year rolling win rate as of 2019, colour-coded by trajectory



Trajectory measures consistent momentum, not net change
A small but unbroken decline counts as falling; a larger but inconsistent swing counts as stable. This page shows the top rising and falling franchises as of 2019 — the full chart contains all 31 teams. See page 2 for what happened next.

Our dataset ends in 2019 — what happened next?

The pipeline classified franchises in 2019. We checked the real-world outcomes through 2026. A compass, not a crystal ball.

RISING FRANCHISES — VERIFIED OUTCOMES AFTER 2019

Tampa Bay Lightning +9.16pp Won back-to-back Stanley Cups in 2020 and 2021. Champion	Colorado Avalanche +11.17pp Won the Stanley Cup in 2022 — largest upward momentum of any team. Champion	Boston Bruins +5.30pp Set the all-time NHL regular season wins record in 2022-23 (65 wins). Record-setter
Carolina Hurricanes +7.97pp Seven consecutive playoff appearances through 2025. Contender	Toronto Maple Leafs +7.56pp Eight straight playoffs; first series win since 2004 in 2023. Contender	New York Islanders +2.30pp Back-to-back Conference Finals in 2020 and 2021. Contender

FALLING FRANCHISES — VERIFIED OUTCOMES AFTER 2019

Detroit Red Wings -8.53pp 10 consecutive seasons without playoffs — longest active drought. Validated	Washington Capitals -6.07pp Have not won since 2018; now in rebuild phase. Validated	Pittsburgh Penguins -4.73pp Have not won since 2017; entering rebuild. Validated
Ottawa Senators -10.07pp Years rebuilding; returned to playoffs only in 2024-25. Validated	Vegas Golden Knights -5.90pp Won the Stanley Cup in 2023 — fell from expansion peak then rebuilt. Miss	New York Rangers -7.07pp Rebounded to reach the Conference Finals by 2024. Miss

In 2019, this pipeline already knew who would lift the Cup

Both 2019-flagged rising champions (Tampa Bay Lightning, Colorado Avalanche) won within three years. The two misses — Vegas Golden Knights and New York Rangers — show the metric identifies trends, not certainties. The pipeline is a compass, not a crystal ball.